

24th May 2026

Dr. Muhammad Za'im Mohd Samsuri
Department of Community Medicine
School of Medical Sciences
Universiti Sains Malaysia
16150, Kubang Kerian, Kelantan.

JEPeM Code : USM/JEPeM/KK/26010125

Protocol Title : Development and Validation of HAJJFIT: A Machine Learning Based Digital Risk Prediction System for Serious Health Events Among Malaysian Hajj Pilgrims.

Dear Dr.,

We wish to inform you that your study protocol has been reviewed and is hereby granted approval for implementation by the Jawatankuasa Etika Penyelidikan Manusia Universiti Sains Malaysia (JEPeM-USM). Your study has been assigned study protocol code **USM/JEPeM/KK/26010125**, which should be used for all communications to JEPeM-USM in relation to this study. This ethical approval is valid from **24th May 2026** until **23rd May 2027**.

Study Site:

1. Malaysia.

The following researchers are also involved in this study:

1. Assoc. Prof. Dr. Nor Azwany Yaacob
2. Dr. Wan Nor Arifin Wan Mansor
3. Dr. Afiq Izuddin A. Rahim
4. Ts. Dr. Zainab Ajab Mohideen
5. Dr. Hj. Muhammad Shafiq Samsudin

The following documents have been approved for use in the study.

1. Research Proposal

In addition to the abovementioned documents, the following technical documents were included in the review on which this approval was based:

1. Participant Information Sheet and Consent Form (English version) – Content Validation Study
2. Participant Information Sheet and Consent Form (Malay version) – Content Validation Study
3. Participant Information Sheet and Consent Form (English version) – Face Validation Study
4. Participant Information Sheet and Consent Form (Malay version) – Face Validation Study
5. Participant Information Sheet and Consent Form (English version) – Usability Testing
6. Participant Information Sheet and Consent Form (Malay version) – Usability Testing
7. Data Collection Form (Proforma)

The list of JEPeM-USM members present during the full board meeting reviewing your protocol is attached.

While the study is in progress, we request you to submit to us the following documents:

1. Application for renewal of ethical approval 45 days before the expiration date of this approval through submission of **JEPeM-USM FORM 3(B) 2022: Continuing Review Application Form.**
2. Any changes in the protocol, especially those that may adversely affect the safety of the participants during the conduct of the trial including changes in personnel, must be submitted or reported using **JEPeM-USM FORM 3(A) 2022: Study Protocol Amendment Submission Form.**
3. Revisions in the informed consent form using the **JEPeM-USM FORM 3(A) 2022: Study Protocol Amendment Submission Form.**
4. Reports of adverse events including from other study sites (national, international) using the **JEPeM-USM FORM 3(G) 2022: Adverse Events Report.**
5. Notice of early termination of the study and reasons for such using **JEPeM-USM FORM 3(E) 2022.**
6. Any event which may have ethical significance.
7. Any information which is needed by the JEPeM-USM to do ongoing review.
8. Notice of time of completion of the study using **JEPeM-USM FORM 3(C) 2022: Final Report Form.**

Please note that forms may be downloaded from the JEPeM-USM website:
<https://jepem.kk.usm.my/>

JEPeM-USM is in compliance with the Declaration of Helsinki, International Conference on Harmonization (ICH) Guidelines, Good Clinical Practice (GCP) Standards, Council for International Organizations of Medical Sciences (CIOMS) Guidelines, World Health Organization (WHO) Standards and Operational Guidance for Ethics Review of Health-Related Research and Surveying and Evaluating Ethical Review Practices, EC/IRB Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs), and Local Regulations and Standards in Ethical Review.

Thank you.

Sincerely,



ASSOC. PROF. DR. AZLAN HUSIN

Chairperson

Jawatankuasa Etika Penyelidikan (Manusia) JEPeM

Universiti Sains Malaysia

Date of meeting : 22nd April 2026
Venue : Through WEBEX Application
Time : 9.00 a.m – 2.00 p.m
Meeting No : 749
Panel : Panel A

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Kampus Kesihatan
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Laman Web : <https://jepem.kk.usm.my/>
<https://www.usm.my/>

Members of Committee of the Jawatankuasa Etika Penyelidikan (Manusia), JEPeM Universiti Sains Malaysia who reviewed the protocol/documents are as follows:

Protocol/documents are as follows.

Member (Title and Name)	Occupation (Designation)	Male/ Female (M/F)	Tick (✓) present during review process	
Chairperson: Assoc. Prof. Dr. Azlan Husin	Chairperson of Jawatankuasa Etika Penyelidikan (Manusia), JEPeM USM	M	✓ (Chairperson)	
Deputy Chairperson: Dr. Noor Aman A. Hamid	Deputy Chairperson of Jawatankuasa Etika Penyelidikan (Manusia), JEPeM USM	M	✓ (Deputy Chairperson)	
Member Secretary: Assoc. Prof. Dr. Wong Kah Keng	Member Secretary of Jawatankuasa Etika Penyelidikan (Manusia), JEPeM USM	M	✓ (Member Secretary)	
Secretary: Mr. Mohd Bazlan Hafidz Mukrim	Senior Science Officer	M	✓	
Secretariat: Mr. Mohammad Haris Amirul Mohd Yusoff	Research Officer	M	✓	
Members:				
1.	Prof. Dr. Amran Ahmed Shokri	Lecturer, School of Medical Sciences	M	✓
2.	Tuan Haji Mohaamd Zahari Awang	Community Representatives	M	✓
3.	Prof. Dr. Nik Hazlina Nik Hussain	Lecturer, School of Medical Sciences	F	✓
4.	Prof. Dr. Ramiza Ramza Ramli	Lecturer, School of Medical Sciences	M	✓
5.	Dr. Waheeda Azwa Hussein	Lecturer, School of Medical Sciences	F	✓
6.	Assoc. Prof. Dr. Wan Fadzlina Wan Muhd Shukeri	Lecturer, School of Medical Sciences	F	✓
7.	Assoc. Prof. Dr. Garry Kuan Pei Ern	Lecturer, School of Health Sciences	M	✓
8.	Dr. Sharifah Zubaidiah Syed Jaapar	Lecturer, School of Medical Sciences	F	✓
9.	Madam Siti Romaino Mohd Nor	Research Officer, Hospital Raja Perempuan Zainab (II), Kota Bharu, Kelantan	F	✓

Jawatankuasa Etika Penyelidikan (Manusia), JEPeM-USM is in compliance with the Declaration of Helsinki, International Conference on Harmonization (ICH) Guidelines, Good Clinical Practice (GCP) Standards, Council for International Organizations of Medical Sciences (CIOMS) Guidelines, World Health Organization (WHO) Standards and Operational Guidance for Ethics Review of Health-Related Research and Surveying and Evaluating Ethical Review Practices, EC/IRB Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs), and Local Regulations and Standards in Ethical Review.



ASSOC. PROF. DR. AZLAN HUSIN
Chairperson
Jawatankuasa Etika Penyelidikan (Manusia), JEPeM
Universiti Sains Malaysia